



56 inch monster monitor

TVLogic LUM-560W is a futuristic 56 inch Quad HD 4K LCD monitor sporting a 1.07 million colour LCD panel



Will this kill USB 3.0?

Intel's Light Peak which boasts of data transfer speeds of 10 Gbps to come out in 2011

Desktop PC test

control dial that gives the keyboard an artistic feel.

The bundled optical mouse feels like it's made of cheaper quality plastic, but its quite responsive and has a rubber coated scroll bar.

The components in the cabinet are neatly laid out, and there's enough space between the DIMM slots and the processor in case you want to change your heatsink solution. The two DDR2 DIMM slots can house up to 4 GB of RAM. The board has one PCI Express x16 slot, a PCI express x1 slot and two PCI slots. The problem area on the board is the gap between the PCI x16 slot and the DIMM slot. There is a very little gap between the two if you are planning to add a large graphics card. Also the four SATA 2.0 ports on the board point upwards rather than sideways which can cause problems. Then again, this PC is not meant for high-end gamers, so these issues are negligible.

The board has two redundant IDE ports just behind the DIMM slots. Space problems arise when attaching

wires there. All the capacitors on the motherboard are electrolytic. Edges inside the motherboard are rounded, to protect you from getting scratched up – thoughtful. The cabinet comes with an inbuilt Delta Electronics power supply which has a moderate 250W rating. An air flow guide is attached on the inner, left-hand side of the cabinet, for enhanced cooling.

We got the Acer P195HQL LCD monitor along with the Acer PCs. This 18.5 inch LCD monitor has a native resolution of 1366 x 768. The P195HQL is surrounded by a black glossy bezel and has a power button on the lower right-hand corner with the monitor controls located just beneath.

We ran DisplayMate on the LCD monitor, and got poor results in tests for black to grey transitions – we could barely tell the shifts between black and grey. Also certain combinations like white text on a yellow background and vice versa were unreadable. The monitor's strictly average, and features DVI and VGA ports.

In terms of performance, we discovered that the Acer Aspire

HOW WE TESTED

We tested all the PCs with the operating systems that they came with. Most of the PCs came with Windows 7. In certain PCs which did not have a pre-installed OS, we installed Windows Vista (32-bit). The proprietary software which would affect performance scores was uninstalled.

While testing a desktop PC, we have to take into consideration many factors as there are lots of components involved. So we used benchmarks like PC Mark Vantage and 3D Mark 06 for testing the core system performance. SiSoft Sandra was used to test the memory performance of the HDD.

In the real world tests we used Cinebench R10 to test the rendering prowess which depends on the processor and system memory. WinRAR

compression decompression gives a good idea of the CPU and memory performance as well. Other than these we had the 4 GB sequential and assorted file transfer tests which gives an idea of the data transfer speeds.

As most of the systems are used to convert file formats we also checked the time it took for converting 100MB VOB file to DivX format. We also checked the gaming prowess of the system by observing the frame rates for games like Doom 3 (at 800x600, medium resolution) and Company of Heroes : Tales of Valour (1024 x 768).

Apart from these tests which were performed on the system, we also looked at the features provided, connectivity options, ease of use, accessories etc and points were allotted accordingly.

IQ4832P had the highest scores in the synthetic benchmarks. It had an overall PC Mark Vantage score of 4,345 with the IP4750P coming in second at 3,899. In the 3D Mark overall scores the IP4750 managed a score of 267. In the real world tests, the IQ4832 was the fastest with the 100 MB VOB to DivX conversion clocking in at 47 seconds. Compare this with 52 seconds for the IP4750

and 65 seconds for the Acer eMachine 3450. As expected, The gaming benchmarks did not yield high scores, with both the IP4750P and the IQ4832P barely managing 25 fps. If you're looking to game, you're going to need a better GPU.

The desktops seem suited for home

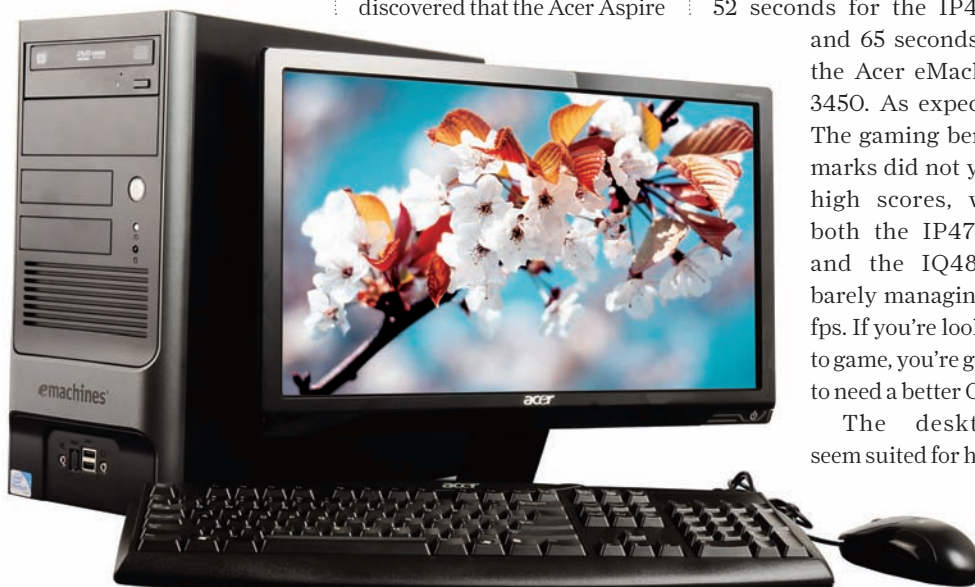
use – documents, surfing the internet and watching movies.

The Acer eMachine 3450 is priced at Rs. 18,999 while the Acer IE3450P sits at around Rs. 24,299. The only difference seems to be the extra stick of RAM in the IE3450P. The IE4750P is priced at Rs. 27,999, while the IQ4832P comes in at Rs. 30,513. Quite competitively priced.

Lenovo B500

Lenovo's B500 IdeaCentre is quite an eye-catcher. An all-in-one (AIO) desktop PC, this machine has quite a unique design thanks to the angular cuts at the right places. The colour theme maintained throughout is black, grey and orange.

The Lenovo B500 is targeted at multimedia enthusiasts, and comes with a 23-inch monitor with a black glossy bezel and tapered corners. Just below the monitor you will find the inbuilt JBL 2.0 speakers. Located just below the monitor is an LED light that runs



Acer eMachines eM3450